

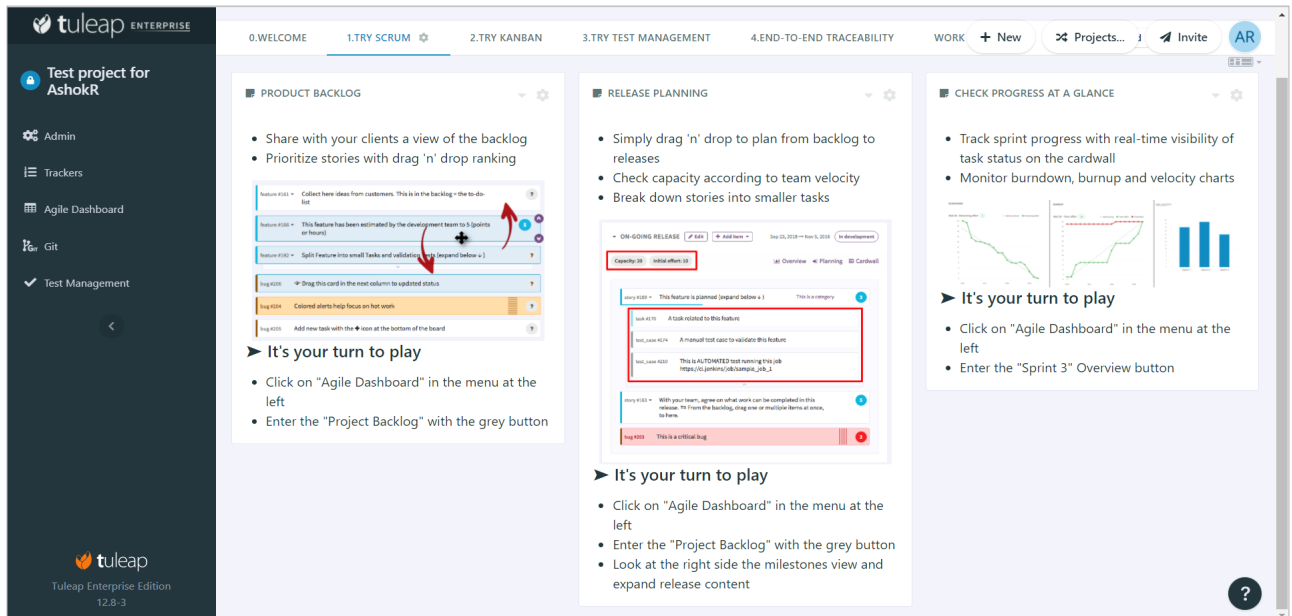


Figure 1: Tuleap Scrum getting started

Setting up a Web app for Scrum is complicated

In the second part of this series of articles (August 2021 issue of *OSFY*), we said that setting up a project server is more complicated than just installing a desktop application. All of those complexities are applicable to setting up a Web app for Scrum as well. Please go through the difficulties outlined in that article and ascertain that you have the in-house technical skills to take on this challenge. Also, make sure that your team pays attention to Web security and takes all necessary precautions.

Install instructions and getting started

As we mentioned previously, install instructions and getting started documents are indispensable to cross the 'starting trouble' stage of open source software successfully. The two open source tools that we feature here provide install instructions and getting started tips for the total newcomer.

Being open source, there is no cost to downloading these tools and trying them out. However, a technical resource has to spend some amount of time to install and configure them and import or enter

some test data to see whether they will suit your needs. Fortunately, both Tuleap and Taiga have online demos. You can register, enter some data and try these out to see whether they will serve your needs. Tuleap has a 'Guided Tour' consisting of four tabs. Based on this initial limited evaluation you can decide whether further effort is warranted.

Basic features of Scrum

For a given product you should be able to create a backlog of stories. Often, you will start at a high-level with parent stories that are called epics in Scrum. When you get closer to starting work on these, you may want to split them into smaller manageable sized stories. The team will refine these stories during backlog refinement sessions by adding acceptance criteria and other details. You should be able to size these stories by assigning each a story point. Work is scheduled typically in two-week cycles called sprints. You should be able to pick a handful of the stories, as prioritised by the product owner (PO), that the team thinks can be completed in a sprint. This is the sprint backlog. During the sprint you should be able to take these stories through different statuses such as in progress, coding completed, code review done, tested, user acceptance and so on.

When each story has met the 'Definition of Done' as previously agreed by the team, the Scrum master (SM) will mark that as complete. At the end of the sprint, hopefully all stories would have been completed. If any are not yet complete, they get moved back to the product backlog for prioritising by the PO. And then the SM can close the sprint, run velocity and other reports, and gather metrics.

Burndown, burnup and velocity are some of the charts that are used in Scrum for planning and monitoring progress. In one of my projects, we maintained a cadence of three sprints followed by a release. In Tuleap and Taiga you can set the number of sprints for a release. Then, in addition to a sprint burndown chart, you can also see a release burndown chart.

Born agile versus added-on agility

When agile software project management became popular, many project management and issue tracking tools force-fitted this capability into their product. This is true of even the popular commercial software Jira. However, some software tools were developed from the get-go to support agile software